PRACTICE EXAM 34 / EXAM SET 05

Domain 6: Communication and Customer Service

12 scored questions	4 answer choices per question	Answer key + explanations included

Instructions

Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. Mark your responses before checking the answer key and detailed explanations at the end of this document. These practice questions are not official NHA examination items.

QUESTIONS

Q01 | Patient-Centered Communication

> **SCENARIO** While a patient describes the reason for a visit, the medical assistant interrupts with an assumption about what happened. The patient says, "That is not what I meant. I had not finished explaining." The assistant recognizes that they interrupted too soon.

Which response best repairs the interruption and restores the patient's opportunity to speak?

A. "I interrupted before you finished. Please continue; I will listen before asking the next question."

B. "Please answer my next question first, and I will return to the point you wanted to make afterward."

C. "I understand, but I need to finish the form before we spend more time on the details."

D. "I was trying to save time by summarizing. Let me explain why I thought that was what you meant."

Q02 | Accessible and Inclusive Communication

> **SCENARIO** A patient who uses American Sign Language is connected to a qualified video remote interpreter. The connection is stable, but the interpreter's image is cropped so the patient cannot see the hands during part of the signing. The patient points out the problem. The assistant is trained to adjust the approved display and camera settings before continuing.

Which action best restores usable interpretation?

A. Continue intake and ask the interpreter to describe missing signs aloud so the patient can follow the rest.

B. Keep the current image and ask the patient to rely on facial expressions when the hands disappear.

C. Pause intake, restore a full, clear view of the interpreter's signing, and confirm usability with the patient.

D. Switch to written English questions and accept written answers without checking whether that method works for this patient.

Q03 | Telephone Written and Virtual Communication

SCENARIO During a verified call, a patient and the patient's adult daughter are both participating at the patient's request. The patient says, "I take my morning medicine every day." The daughter says, "I think some doses were missed, but I do not know which days." The assistant will relay the differing reports to the nurse for review and has verified the callback number.

Which message best preserves the information without choosing one account as established fact?

A. The patient reports daily morning doses; the daughter suspects missed doses but cannot identify dates. Both reports need nurse review.

B. The patient has been missing morning doses, according to the daughter; the patient's statement was excluded because it conflicts with hers.

C. The patient confirms daily morning doses; the daughter's concerns were omitted because she could not provide specific dates for the missed doses.

D. The patient and daughter agree that morning doses are taken most days, so I advised the patient to continue the current routine.

Q04 | Teamwork Conflict and Professionalism

SCENARIO While a patient is present, a coworker comments to a medical assistant, "Your typing is too slow; you always hold things up." There is no immediate safety issue. The assistant wants to remain receptive to useful feedback while keeping a personal workflow discussion out of the patient interaction.

Which response best establishes an appropriate setting for constructive feedback?

A. "I am willing to review my workflow. Please discuss the specific concern with me privately after we finish helping this patient."

B. "I disagree with that description. Let me show you the other delays that caused this appointment to run behind today."

C. "Please ask the patient whether my typing seems too slow; that will help us settle whose view is more accurate."

D. "I will work faster if you promise not to mention any concerns about my performance to me or the supervisor again."

Q05 | Accessible and Inclusive Communication

SCENARIO A patient comfortably exchanges greetings in English at check-in. When clinical intake begins, the patient says, "I can chat in English, but I explain my health concerns better in Vietnamese." A qualified Vietnamese interpreter is available. A coworker suggests that the earlier English conversation shows an interpreter is unnecessary.

Which response best addresses the difference between casual conversation and the patient's stated clinical communication need?

A. Continue in English and arrange interpretation only if the patient becomes unable to answer any questions at all.

B. Use English because the greetings were fluent, and offer a Vietnamese printout to replace discussion of difficult concerns.

C. Ask the patient to practice describing concerns in English first so staff can decide whether their preference is justified.

D. Arrange the qualified interpreter for intake because conversational English does not establish comfort discussing health concerns in English.

Q06 | Patient-Centered Communication

SCENARIO During intake, a patient says, "In my family, we usually talk through health choices together before I decide." The patient has not asked the assistant to contact anyone or disclose information. The assistant wants to understand what the patient would like the provider to know about this preference.

Which question best explores the individual's preference without assuming how the family should participate?

A. "Which relative should the provider address instead of you when there is a health decision to make at today's appointment?"

B. "How would you like your family involved in discussions, and what would you like me to tell the provider about that?"

C. "Would you agree to make decisions alone during visits so the clinic can keep the same approach for every patient?"

D. "Should I assume that all future care discussions must wait until every member of your family is able to attend?"

Q07 | Telephone Written and Virtual Communication

SCENARIO At the start of a routine virtual intake, a patient says, "I am in a shared work area. People can hear me, and I cannot talk freely about why I made this appointment." There is no reported urgent concern. Clinic policy directs the assistant to pause substantive intake and ask the clinician to coordinate a suitable private setting or approved alternative when the patient cannot speak freely.

Which response best supports an effective conversation under the stated policy?

A. "Please give yes-or-no answers so we can finish the same intake without discussing the sensitive parts of your concern."

B. "Use headphones and continue describing your concern aloud; headphones will prevent people nearby from hearing your answers."

C. "Let's pause the intake. I will ask the clinician to help arrange a setting or approved option where you can speak freely."

D. "I will cancel this visit now and mark it as completed because we established a connection even though you cannot talk."

Q08 | Teamwork Conflict and Professionalism

SCENARIO A patient complains, "Nobody called me back about my question." The service log shows an attempted call that reached no answer; it does not show a completed conversation or a message received by the patient. The assistant can verify the callback number and request follow-up from the responsible team.

Which response best acknowledges the complaint while accurately describing the record?

A. "The log shows a call, so our team completed the response. Please check with your phone company about why you did not receive it."

B. "You are right that nobody tried to call. I will tell the supervisor that the team ignored your request and failed to respond."

C. "I see an attempted call, but no completed conversation. Let's verify your number and ask the team to follow up on your question."

D. "We tried once, which is the same as reaching you. Please submit a new question if you still need a response from the team."

Q09 | Telephone Written and Virtual Communication

SCENARIO The clinic asks a medical assistant to add a clear message about portal response expectations. Its current policy states that routine portal questions are reviewed within two business days and that patients needing a same-day response should call the clinic's triage line. Portal submissions are not monitored continuously.

Which wording most accurately communicates the channel's limits and the available alternative?

A. Portal questions are monitored continuously. Calling the triage line is unnecessary because staff can detect when a written question needs attention.

B. Portal questions receive an immediate response during the day. If an answer is delayed, send the same message again to mark it urgent.

C. Portal questions are reviewed within two calendar days, including weekends. For a faster answer, label your message as a same-day request.

D. Routine portal questions are reviewed within two business days. If you need a same-day response, call the clinic's triage line.

Q10 | Patient-Centered Communication

SCENARIO During intake, a patient who uses a wheelchair tells the standing medical assistant, "Looking up at you is uncomfortable for my neck. Could we talk at the same level?" A chair is available beside the patient, with enough room to keep a comfortable distance and leave the route clear.

Which response best aligns nonverbal behavior with the patient's request?

A. Continue standing and speak more slowly so the patient can listen without needing to look directly at the assistant.

B. Crouch very close to the patient's face and rest a hand on the wheelchair to show full attention during the intake.

C. Ask the patient's companion to answer from a standing position so the assistant does not need to change the room arrangement.

D. Sit in the available chair at a comfortable eye level and distance, then continue addressing the patient directly.

Q11 | Accessible and Inclusive Communication

SCENARIO Kai, who uses they/them pronouns, communicates by pointing to a portable picture-and-letter board. Intake is complete, and Kai is moving with staff to another room for the provider conversation. The board is still on the intake desk. Kai indicates that they need it in the next room and can point to it when it is placed within reach.

Which action best maintains communication access during the transition?

A. Leave the board at intake because the answers already collected should be enough for the provider to complete the next conversation.

B. Bring the board with Kai and place it within their reach as requested so they can use it during the provider conversation.

C. Copy the earlier answers onto a note and ask the provider to use that note instead of bringing the patient's communication board.

D. Ask an accompanying person to speak for Kai in the next room while the board is kept at the intake desk for later use.

Q12 | Teamwork Conflict and Professionalism

> **SCENARIO** A medical assistant hears a coworker repeatedly imitate patients' accents in a mocking manner near the reception area. The assistant has privately asked the coworker to stop, but the behavior continues. Clinic policy directs staff to report persistent disrespectful conduct to the supervisor with factual examples rather than trying repeated informal reminders.

Which action best follows the escalation process while remaining objective?

A. Report the observed words and circumstances, the request to stop, and the continued behavior to the supervisor under the clinic policy.

B. Wait until a patient submits a formal complaint because staff observations alone do not justify bringing the situation to the supervisor.

C. Make a general announcement that everyone should be respectful and avoid reporting the specific continued behavior to the supervisor.

D. Ask several coworkers to join in criticizing the person's character so the supervisor will understand how unpopular the behavior has become.

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

Practice Exam 34 | Domain 6: Communication and Customer Service | 12 scored questions

01 A	02 C	03 A	04 A	05 D	06 B
07 C	08 C	09 D	10 D	11 B	12 A

DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

Q01 | Correct answer: A

"I interrupted before you finished. Please continue; I will listen before asking the next question."

The response acknowledges the specific communication error and returns the floor to the patient. It gives the assistant a chance to hear the account before making another inference. Defending the interruption or delaying the patient's explanation repeats the barrier the patient identified.

Q02 | Correct answer: C

Pause intake, restore a full, clear view of the interpreter's signing, and confirm usability with the patient.

Effective signed interpretation requires a sufficiently clear, complete image rather than a stable connection alone. The trained assistant can correct the framing and verify that the patient can follow the interpretation before resuming. An untested substitute or inference from partial signing does not resolve the stated barrier.

Q03 | Correct answer: A

The patient reports daily morning doses; the daughter suspects missed doses but cannot identify dates. Both reports need nurse review.

The message attributes each account to its source and preserves the uncertainty for the nurse to clarify. It neither turns a suspicion into a confirmed omission nor erases a concern because dates are unknown. Combining the accounts into an agreement would invent information that neither speaker supplied.

Q04 | Correct answer: A

"I am willing to review my workflow. Please discuss the specific concern with me privately after we finish helping this patient."

The response remains open to a specific concern and requests a private, appropriate time to discuss it. It protects the patient interaction without denying that improvement may be needed. Arguing about blame, involving the patient as a judge, or trying to prohibit future feedback does not support constructive resolution.

Q05 | Correct answer: D

Arrange the qualified interpreter for intake because conversational English does not establish comfort discussing health concerns in English.

The patient's own description identifies a need for language assistance during the health discussion despite fluent social greetings. The available qualified interpreter supports that need without requiring the patient to fail an English interview first. Casual conversation and a written handout do not establish effective two-way clinical communication.

Q06 | Correct answer: B

"How would you like your family involved in discussions, and what would you like me to tell the provider about that?"

The question asks the patient to define the desired family role and what should be relayed to the provider. It does not infer that relatives replace the patient or that a family practice applies identically in every situation. Exploring a preference does not itself authorize contacting anyone or sharing information.

Q07 | Correct answer: C

"Let's pause the intake. I will ask the clinician to help arrange a setting or approved option where you can speak freely."

The patient has identified an environmental barrier to giving a complete account, and the supplied policy states how to respond. Headphones can limit incoming sound but do not prevent others from hearing the patient's spoken answers. Reducing the interview to yes-or-no questions or independently treating the visit as completed does not resolve the barrier.

Q08 | Correct answer: C

"I see an attempted call, but no completed conversation. Let's verify your number and ask the team to follow up on your question."

The response distinguishes an attempted call from successful communication and offers concrete follow-up. It respects the patient's report without claiming that staff made no attempt. A log entry alone does not establish that the patient received an answer.

Q09 | Correct answer: D

Routine portal questions are reviewed within two business days. If you need a same-day response, call the clinic's triage line.

The wording preserves the policy's business-day review window and directs same-day needs to the designated telephone channel. A review timeframe does not promise an immediate clinical answer or continuous monitoring. Calendar days, duplicate submissions, and urgent labels would misrepresent how the portal operates.

Q10 | Correct answer: D

Sit in the available chair at a comfortable eye level and distance, then continue addressing the patient directly.

Sitting in the available chair addresses the specific discomfort and supports a direct conversation without invading the patient's space. The request does not indicate that a companion should speak for the patient. Touching the wheelchair or moving very close is unnecessary to adjust the assistant's speaking position.

Q11 | Correct answer: B

Bring the board with Kai and place it within their reach as requested so they can use it during the provider conversation.

The communication aid needs to remain available for the patient's next exchange, rather than being treated as equipment used only for intake. Kai has specified both the need and a workable position. Earlier answers or another person's account do not replace the ability to ask new questions and express current responses.

Q12 | Correct answer: A

Report the observed words and circumstances, the request to stop, and the continued behavior to the supervisor under the clinic policy.

The behavior has persisted after a direct request to stop, and the policy identifies the next reporting step. Concrete observations and the attempted resolution help the supervisor evaluate and address the conduct. Character judgments, waiting for a patient complaint, or another nonspecific reminder do not follow the stated escalation process.

End of Practice Exam